



Simple Past VS Past Perfect

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Quick Reminder

- **Past Simple:** completed actions in the past.
- **Past Perfect:** actions completed **before** another action in the past (had + past participle).

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks (Mixed)

Complete with **Past Simple** or **Past Perfect**.

1. By the time the show _____ (start), we _____ (find) our seats.
2. She _____ (leave) the office before I _____ (arrive).
3. After they _____ (finish) dinner, they _____ (go) for a walk.
4. When I _____ (get) to the station, the train _____ (already / leave).
5. He _____ (be) tired because he _____ (not / sleep) well the night before.
6. The children _____ (tidy) up the room after they _____ (play) with their toys.
7. We _____ (not / eat) anything until we _____ (arrive) at the restaurant.
8. They _____ (visit) many countries by the time they _____ (turn) thirty.

9. She _____ (realize) she _____ (lose) her keys after she _____ (get) home.
10. Before he _____ (move) to New York, he _____ (live) in Los Angeles.

Exercise 2: Multiple Choice

Choose the correct option.

1. By the time we _____ to the party, it _____ raining.
(a) got / had stopped (b) had got / stopped (c) got / stopped
2. He _____ the letter before I _____ a chance to read it.
(a) had sent / had (b) sent / had (c) had sent / got
3. They _____ the project before the deadline, so they _____ to relax.
(a) finished / had (b) had finished / got (c) had finished / were able
4. When she _____ the book, she _____ it on the shelf.

- (a) finished / had put (b) had finished / put (c) finished / put
5. The teacher _____ the test results after the students _____ the class.
(a) announced / had left (b) had announced / left (c) announced / left
6. I _____ to the supermarket because I _____ everything I needed.
(a) didn't go / had bought (b) didn't go / bought (c) hadn't gone / had bought
7. After the storm _____, the sun _____ brightly.
(a) had passed / shone (b) passed / had shone (c) passed / shone
8. The movie _____ when we _____ at the cinema.
(a) had started / arrived (b) started / had arrived (c) had started / had arrived
9. She _____ a new job after she _____ from her previous company.
(a) had found / resigned (b) found / resigned (c) found / had resigned
10. They _____ the match by the time we _____ at the stadium.
(a) had won / arrived (b) won / arrived (c) had won / had arrived
3. (they / a / finished / dinner / after / they / walk / went / for) →

4. (got / station / train / I / the / already / when / had / left / the) →

5. (had / tired / because / he / not / slept / was / he / well) →

Exercise 4: Error Correction

Correct the mistakes.

1. She left the office before I had arrived.
→

2. They went home after they had finished their work. →

3. When we arrived, the movie had started already. →

4. He had never seen such a beautiful place before he visited Hawaii. →

5. The children cleaned their room after they had played. →

Exercise 3: Sentence Formation

Rearrange the words to form correct sentences.

1. (already / the / film / started / when / arrived / I) →

2. (before / the / had / left / office / she / called / he) →

Exercise 5: Narrative Text

Complete with Past Simple or Past Perfect.

Last weekend, I _____ (decide) to visit my grandparents. By the time I _____ (arrive) at their house, they _____ (already / prepare) a delicious lunch. After we _____ (eat), we _____ (sit) in the garden and _____ (talk) about old times. My grandmother _____ (tell) me stories about when she _____ (be) a child. She

_____ (say) that she _____ (never / (realize) that I _____ (forget) to call my
see) a more beautiful garden than theirs. Later, friend. By the time I _____ (call) him, he
we _____ (go) for a walk in the nearby _____ (already / leave) his house.
park. When we _____ (get) back, it
_____ (already / get) dark. I _____